



The Opinion Line

A statement goes on the board and everyone stands somewhere on a line between agree and disagree, then two or three of them say why they stood where they did. It gets a form used to disagreeing with each other out loud, and to moving when somebody makes a better point. The slides come in three sets: Year 7 to 9, Year 10 and 11, and sixth form.

Before you start. The statements are about opinions rather than anything personal, and nobody has to explain where they are standing. If a statement lands near something that is already going on in your form, skip it and use the next one.

Print these

Page	What it is
Page 2	Fifteen more statements, five for each set, for when the slides run out
Page 3	The agree sign, for one wall
Page 4	The disagree sign, for the wall opposite

How it works

Step	What happens	Slides
1	Put the two signs up at opposite ends of the room before the first morning. They can stay up all year.	1
2	Put the morning's statement on the board and read it out once, without saying what you think.	2 to 6
3	Everyone stands somewhere between the two signs. The middle is a real answer, and so is moving while they are still deciding.	
4	Ask two or three of them why they stood where they did, then ask whether anybody wants to move.	
5	When the five in the slides and the five on page 2 are used up, the last slide asks students to bring you a statement of their own.	7

Worth knowing

- Download the set for your form. The statements get more abstract as the sets go up, and a Year 7 statement will not split a Year 12 room.
- In a small room, run the line along one wall instead, from the door to the window. Nobody has to move any furniture for it.
- Moving is the part worth praising out loud. Changing your mind because somebody said something good is a difficult thing to do in front of thirty people, and nobody will do it unless you say that it counts.

New sets and new activities go up on thepastoralguide.com as they are written. Leave your email there and you will hear when they do.





Fifteen more statements

Five for each set, for when the slides run out. Read one out, or write it on the board, and run the line the same way.

For Year 7 to 9

1. Rules still matter when nobody is watching.
2. It is fine to give up on something you are not good at.
3. Saying sorry is enough.
4. It is braver to walk away than to argue back.
5. Everyone deserves a second chance.

For Year 10 and 11

1. It is fine to lie to a parent to keep the peace.
2. Being good at something matters more than enjoying it.
3. Nobody under eighteen should be able to be famous.
4. You can tell what somebody is like from what they post.
5. The person who starts a fight is always more to blame than the person who finishes it.

For sixth form

1. Ambition is mostly a fear of being ordinary.
2. Talent is just practice that started early.
3. A person is responsible for what they fail to notice.
4. It is better to regret something you did than something you did not do.
5. You cannot really know somebody you have only known at school.

After these, the statements come from the form. The best ones are the ones the person suggesting them is not sure about.



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Agree

Stand at this end if you agree with the statement.

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Disagree

Stand at this end if you disagree with the statement.